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Java SE 27 & JDK 27

Class StringJoiner

java.lang.Object
    java.util.StringJoiner

```
public final class StringJoiner
extends Object
```

`StringJoiner` is used to construct a sequence of characters separated by a delimiter and optionally starting with a supplied prefix and ending with a supplied suffix.

Prior to adding something to the `StringJoiner`, its `sj.toString()` method will, by default, return `prefix + suffix`. However, if the `setEmptyValue` method is called, the `emptyValue` supplied will be returned instead. This can be used, for example, when creating a string using set notation to indicate an empty set, i.e. `"{}"`, where the `prefix` is `"{"`, the `suffix` is `"}"` and nothing has been added to the `StringJoiner`.

API Note:

The String `"[George:Sally:Fred]"` may be constructed as follows:

```
StringJoiner sj = new StringJoiner(":", "[", "]");
sj.add("George").add("Sally").add("Fred");
String desiredString = sj.toString();
```

A `StringJoiner` may be employed to create formatted output from a `Stream` using `Collectors.joining(CharSequence)`. For example:

```
List<Integer> numbers = Arrays.asList(1, 2, 3, 4);
String commaSeparatedNumbers = numbers.stream()
    .map(i -> i.toString())
    .collect(Collectors.joining(", "));
```

Since:

1.8

See Also:

`Collectors.joining(CharSequence)`,
`Collectors.joining(CharSequence, CharSequence, CharSequence)`

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Constructor	Description

StringJoiner (CharSequence delimiter)	Constructs a StringJoiner with no characters in it, with no prefix or suffix, and a copy of the supplied delimiter.
StringJoiner (CharSequence delimiter, CharSequence prefix, CharSequence suffix)	Constructs a StringJoiner with no characters in it using copies of the supplied prefix, delimiter and suffix.

Method Summary

All Methods | Instance Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
StringJoiner	**add** (CharSequence newElement	Adds a copy of the given CharSequence value as the next element of the StringJoiner value.
int	**length**()	Returns the length of the String representation of this StringJoiner.
StringJoiner	**merge** (StringJoiner other)	Adds the contents of the given StringJoiner without prefix and suffix as the next element if it is non-empty.
StringJoiner	**setEmptyValue** (CharSequence emptyValue	Sets the sequence of characters to be used when determining the string representation of this StringJoiner and no elements have been added yet, that is, when it is empty.
String	**toString**()	Returns the current value, consisting of the prefix, the values added so far separated by the delimiter, and the

	suffix, unless no elements have been added in which case, the prefix + suffix or the emptyValue characters are returned.

Methods declared in class Object

clone, equals, finalize, getClass, hashCode, notify, notifyAll, wait, wait, wait

Constructor Details

StringJoiner

```
public StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter)
```

Constructs a StringJoiner with no characters in it, with no prefix or suffix, and a copy of the supplied delimiter. If no characters are added to the StringJoiner and methods accessing the value of it are invoked, it will not return a prefix or suffix (or properties thereof) in the result, unless setEmptyValue has first been called.

Parameters:

delimiter - the sequence of characters to be used between each element added to the StringJoiner value

Throws:

NullPointerException - if delimiter is null

StringJoiner

```
public StringJoiner(CharSequence delimiter,
                    CharSequence prefix,
                    CharSequence suffix)
```

Constructs a StringJoiner with no characters in it using copies of the supplied prefix, delimiter and suffix. If no characters are added to the StringJoiner and methods accessing the string value of it are invoked, it will

return the `prefix + suffix` (or properties thereof) in the result, unless `setEmptyValue` has first been called.

Parameters:

`delimiter` - the sequence of characters to be used between each element added to the `StringJoiner`

`prefix` - the sequence of characters to be used at the beginning

`suffix` - the sequence of characters to be used at the end

Throws:

`NullPointerException` - if `prefix`, `delimiter`, or `suffix` is `null`

Method Details

setEmptyValue

```
public StringJoiner setEmptyValue(CharSequence emptyValue)
```

Sets the sequence of characters to be used when determining the string representation of this `StringJoiner` and no elements have been added yet, that is, when it is empty. A copy of the `emptyValue` parameter is made for this purpose. Note that once an add method has been called, the `StringJoiner` is no longer considered empty, even if the element(s) added correspond to the empty `String`.

Parameters:

`emptyValue` - the characters to return as the value of an empty `StringJoiner`

Returns:

this `StringJoiner` itself so the calls may be chained

Throws:

`NullPointerException` - when the `emptyValue` parameter is `null`

toString

```
public String toString()
```

Returns the current value, consisting of the `prefix`, the values added so far separated by the `delimiter`, and the `suffix`, unless no elements have been added in which case, the `prefix + suffix` or the `emptyValue` characters are returned.

Overrides:

`toString` in class `Object`

Returns:

the string representation of this `StringJoiner`

add

```
public StringJoiner add(CharSequence newElement)
```

Adds a copy of the given `CharSequence` value as the next element of the `StringJoiner` value. If `newElement` is `null`, then `"null"` is added.

Parameters:

`newElement` - The element to add

Returns:

a reference to this `StringJoiner`

merge

```
public StringJoiner merge(StringJoiner other)
```

Adds the contents of the given `StringJoiner` without prefix and suffix as the next element if it is non-empty. If the given `StringJoiner` is empty, the call has no effect.

A `StringJoiner` is empty if `add()` has never been called, and if `merge()` has never been called with a non-empty `StringJoiner` argument.

If the other `StringJoiner` is using a different delimiter, then elements from the other `StringJoiner` are concatenated with that delimiter and the result is appended to this `StringJoiner` as a single element.

Parameters:

`other` - The `StringJoiner` whose contents should be merged into this one

Returns:

This `StringJoiner`

Throws:

`NullPointerException` - if the other `StringJoiner` is null

length

```
public int length()
```

Returns the length of the `String` representation of this `StringJoiner`. Note that if no add methods have been called, then the length of the `String` representation (either `prefix + suffix` or `emptyValue`) will be returned. The value should be equivalent to `toString().length()`.

Returns:

the length of the current value of `StringJoiner`

Report a bug or suggest an enhancement
For further API reference and developer documentation see the Java SE Documentation, which contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples. Other versions.
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